Abdullah Al Zahid

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Human Resources
Defence Construction Canada, Ottawa, ON

Re: Technical Specialist, Real Property Management (Real Property Spatial Data Requirements Specialist)

Dear Hiring Manager,

I would like to apply for the Real Property Spatial Data Requirements Specialist position with the Spatial Data Services Program. My background is in transportation planning, and the part of it that overlaps with this role is spatial data: building it, validating it and making it usable.

At the City of Toronto I build and maintain the road and right-of-way datasets that Transportation Planning depends on, including a right-of-way width dataset covering all city roads, built with QGIS, MapBox and JavaScript. I also built the Transportation Data Dashboard, which brought several years of data into one validated source the division reports from. I work in ArcGIS Pro, QGIS, AutoCAD and Civil 3D, and in Python and SQL. I write the briefing notes and presentations that explain data to the people who use it, and I coordinate with divisions and consultants whose needs differ.

At Metrolinx I set up a command line workflow that pre-simulated slow orders in batches, cutting turnaround on scenario requests from days to hours, and built the Crew Variance Tool, a Python application that read large JSON operations files and summarised speed profiles and run-time variance across subdivisions.

I should be straightforward about the gaps. I have no experience in real property or facilities data, and I have not used Building Information Modelling software. I have not written statements of operational requirements or business cases, or worked as a business analyst, and I have not led data management projects or dealt with Department of National Defence systems. I am not bilingual in French, which the posting prefers. I am applying because spatial data work is the part of my experience I would most like to grow, and I would learn the real property side.

Thank you for considering my application.

Sincerely,

Abdullah Al Zahid

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